



Soundcore Infini Pro

Soundcore's new Dolby Atmos speaker equipped with dual 2.5-inch mid-range drivers has launched in India. <http://digit.in/feb21-79>



JBL C115

JBL's latest TWS sports 5.88mm dynamic drivers and boasts 21 hours of overall battery life; 6 hours playback. <http://digit.in/feb21-80>

Alienware 310H Gaming Headset

No frills mid-range headset for gamers

Gaming headsets are a dime a dozen today, with brands pushing to bring their own offerings into this lucrative market. Alienware is a brand that is renowned in the gaming world and the company has a good lineup of gaming headsets, across several price points as well. The company has now come out with the Alienware 310H stereo gaming headset which is a mid-range, wired gaming headset, priced at ₹8,429, but available for ₹7,999 on Amazon. Is the headset a good value proposition for gamers? Let's find out, shall we?

Build and comfort

The Alienware 310H gaming headset isn't a flashy one when it comes to the aesthetics. The headset is all-black and has a matte texture. The earcups are a hybrid of plush memory foam, sports fabric, and leatherette. These materials are meant to optimise cooling and comfort while maintaining noise isolation. In our tests, we found that the material was adequately breathable and was extremely comfortable to don. The ear cups are well-padded and the clamping force isn't too tight as well. The cups can also be rotated 90-degrees to sit flat on your chest or on a surface.

The headband can be extended on both sides to quite a degree. The headband is padded and sits comfortably on the head. The padding was a bit too hard for our liking, but it doesn't get overly uncomfortable at any point.

The cups isolate external noise pretty well, however, due to the noise isolating fit they do get hot at times. The left ear cup houses a retractable boom microphone, which slides in and out with ease. The headset also has a small in-line remote control with a volume controlling scroll wheel. There's also a pretty discreet microphone mute switch on the back on the module that can be flicked down to mute the mic and flicked up to unmute.



The Alienware 310H is a wired headset that has a 3.5mm audio cable. The company has also provided a Y-splitter cable in the box. According to Alienware, the headset comes with cross-platform compatibility and can be used with PCs, laptops, consoles, Nintendo Switch and mobile devices. We used the headset with a PC for this review.

Overall, the headset is comfortable and robust, however, it is certainly lacking a gaming aesthetic that is prevalent on a lot of gaming headsets on the market these days.

Features

The Alienware 310H isn't feature-rich, by any means. However, it does come with a Discord-certified microphone, which in our testing, proved to be pretty commendable for the price point. The voice was relayed clearly and it didn't sound distorted or distant as some entry to mid-range gaming headset microphones do. However, a fair amount of external sounds are picked up by the microphone and relayed to your teammates.

Performance

Equipped with custom-tuned 50mm drivers for Hi-Res Audio, the Alien-

ware 310H have a frequency response from 20Hz to 40kHz. The headset employs Alienware's Immersive Audio Technology to power its gaming performance. The headset has pretty decent gaming performance, however, there are some issues. First, let's talk about the positive. Background scores and soundtracks within games sound pretty good on these headphones.

Sounds such as explosions are impactful as well. The imaging on these headphones is pretty stellar, and you'll be able to pinpoint the direction the enemy is coming from. However, the bass response is exaggerated on these headphones, so in FPS games gunshots sound boomy and mar the immersiveness. Being closed-back headphones, the soundstage is slightly limited as well. We played Valorant using this headset. The experience was decent, however, we wish that the gunshots sounded a bit more impactful.

Verdict

The Alienware 310H has a robust build and comfortable fit, allowing gamers to play for hours on end without any overbearing discomfort. The headset isn't the best-sounding for FPS games, however, for other genres of games the headset is pretty competent, with good imaging and dynamic sound.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

PRODUCT TYPE: wired headset 3.5 mm jack | RECOMMENDED USE: Computer | CONTROLS: In-Line on USB DAC with Volume & Mic Mute control | HEADPHONES FORM FACTOR: Full size, closed-back | CONNECTIVITY TECHNOLOGY: Wired | SOUND OUTPUT MODE: Stereo | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20 - 40000 Hz | IMPEDANCE: 32 Ohm | MICROPHONE: Boom | MICROPHONE OPERATION MODE: Uni-directional | ACCESSORIES: Y-Splitter for separate mic and headphone jacks

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